

Name: _____

Date: _____

Jordan was halfway across the gravel path when he saw why the puddle would not shrink. Wet leaves had packed against the metal grate, and the rainwater had nowhere to go but over his shoes. People were stepping into the grass to get around it. If the clog stayed, the path would remain a pond until the next dry day.

He did not pull the grate up alone. The metal was heavy, and the hole under it was deep. He found Ms. Alvarez, the park worker, and showed her the leaves. Together they lifted the grate onto the grass. Jordan raked leaves into a bucket while she cleared the mud with a shovel. They kept working until the opening was clear.

Water dropped through the drain, and the gravel slowly reappeared. Ms. Alvarez carried the bucket to the compost bin and thanked him. On the way home Jordan explained that a blocked drain, not just the rain, had flooded the path. He planned to check that grate after the next storm.

Fill in the circle next to the best answer.

1. What is causing the puddle on the path?

- ☐ A. Leaves packed against the grate are blocking the drain.
- ☐ B. Ms. Alvarez opened the grate and left it in the grass.
- ☐ C. Jordan is pouring water over the path from a bucket.
- ☐ D. The gravel path was built below the creek on purpose.

2. Why doesn't Jordan lift the grate by himself?

- ☐ A. It is heavy, and the hole underneath is deep.
- ☐ B. He wants the path to stay flooded for the week.
- ☐ C. The leaves are already gone when he arrives.
- ☐ D. Ms. Alvarez tells him the puddle is supposed to stay.

3. What happens after they clear the opening?

- ☐ A. They leave the grate in the grass overnight.
- ☐ B. The water drops and the gravel path shows again.
- ☐ C. Jordan decides rain alone caused the flood.
- ☐ D. The puddle grows until it covers the compost bin.

Name: _____ Date: _____

The class time capsule would not latch. The wooden lid had swollen after a night in a damp closet, and the metal clasp missed its loop by a finger's width. Inside were letters the students wanted opened in ten years. Forcing the wood could crack it and ruin the letters.

Owen suggested pressing harder. Mr. Ellis said force would split the lid. Instead they set the box, lid open, in the sunny hallway and aimed a fan across the wood. Every hour someone checked that the papers stayed inside and dry. Owen kept a list of the checks so the box would not be forgotten at dismissal.

By the end of the day the lid sat flat and the clasp clicked. Owen still worried about another wet night, so he wrapped twine around the box as a backup and tucked the knot underneath. They stored the capsule on a high shelf in the dry office, and Owen wrote the shelf number on a class note.

Fill in the circle next to the best answer.

1. What is wrong with the time capsule?

- ☐ A. Mr. Ellis wants the box stored in the closet again.
- ☐ B. The letters inside were written for the wrong year.
- ☐ C. The damp lid has swollen and will not latch.
- ☐ D. The fan in the hallway will not turn on.

2. Why do they reject Owen's first idea?

- ☐ A. Pressing harder could crack the wood.
- ☐ B. The clasp already fits without any drying.
- ☐ C. Twine is the only material they are allowed to use.
- ☐ D. The papers are too wet to move into the hall.

3. How do they get the box to close?

- ☐ A. They dry the open lid in the sun with a fan.
- ☐ B. They remove the letters and throw the box away.
- ☐ C. They return it to the damp closet overnight.
- ☐ D. They force the clasp until the wood splits.

Name: _____ Date: _____

Thunder rolled just as the relay teams lined up. The sky that had been pale all morning turned the color of a bruise. Ms. Alvarez blew a whistle and pointed to the wide awning beside the gym. Students groaned about canceled races. Standing in the open, with metal poles nearby, was not safe.

Ms. Alvarez said the races were not canceled, only moved. She marked a shorter track with cones under the awning, away from the poles. The relay would be two legs instead of four so nobody would crowd the dry strip. Jonah's team complained, then practiced the handoff twice in the small space. The second practice was clean.

When they ran, the baton did not drop. They did not win, but they finished. Rain tapped the awning like drums. Jonah was soaked only at the edges of his sleeves. Field day had shrunk, but it had not disappeared. He still talked about the handoff on the ride home.

Fill in the circle next to the best answer.

1. Why can't the relay stay on the field?

- ☐ A. The class forgot to bring a baton.
- ☐ B. The awning is too wet to stand under.
- ☐ C. Ms. Alvarez wants to cancel every event for the year.
- ☐ D. Thunder makes the open field and the metal poles unsafe.

2. How does the race change under the awning?

- ☐ A. It becomes a shorter track with two legs instead of four.
- ☐ B. Runners must touch the metal poles as they pass.
- ☐ C. Jonah's team refuses to practice and still wins.
- ☐ D. The teams skip the handoff entirely.

3. What shows that the new plan works?

- ☐ A. The class returns to the open field.
- ☐ B. The cones blow away and end the race before anyone finishes.
- ☐ C. Jonah's team finishes without dropping the baton.
- ☐ D. The storm stops before anyone runs.

Name: _____ Date: _____

A brown wallet sat on the park bench where Mateo had tied his shoe. He looked around the playground, but the family who had been there was gone. The wallet was thick with cards. Leaving it felt wrong, and digging through it on the sidewalk felt wrong too. Anyone walking by could have watched him do it.

Mateo carried it to the rec center desk. The worker, Mr. Shah, opened it while Mateo watched. A student ID showed the name Luis Ortega, and the office phone list had his house. They called. Mateo did not take any card out of the wallet himself.

Luis and his dad arrived before Mateo finished his water bottle. Luis checked the cards and let out a long breath. Nothing was missing. His dad thanked them for not leaving the wallet on the bench. Mr. Shah said the desk was the right place for anything found in the park, and Mateo agreed before he headed home.

Fill in the circle next to the best answer.

1. What does Mateo find, and why is it a problem?

- ☐ A. A phone list with his own name on it
- ☐ B. A wallet whose owner has already left the playground
- ☐ C. A bench that the rec center wants removed from the park
- ☐ D. A student ID that belongs to Mr. Shah

2. Why doesn't Mateo search the wallet on the sidewalk?

- ☐ A. Mr. Shah tells him to leave it on the bench.
- ☐ B. Luis is still sitting beside him.
- ☐ C. The wallet is empty when he picks it up.
- ☐ D. People walking by could watch him go through it.

3. How is the wallet returned?

- ☐ A. The rec center calls Luis using the ID inside.
- ☐ B. Mr. Shah keeps the wallet as a lost item forever.
- ☐ C. Luis finds it himself still on the bench.
- ☐ D. Mateo takes the cards home for the night.

Name: _____ Date: _____

The lettuce bed looked tired. Outer leaves drooped even though the morning had been cool. Noor knelt and pushed a finger into the soil. It was dry a knuckle down. The sprinkler had been aimed at the path, not the bed, for three days. Water on the path did not help roots.

Noor told the garden club at lunch. They did not flood the plants all at once. She showed them how to water at the roots, slowly, until the soil held together without turning to mud. Then they moved the sprinkler and set a can on the path as a marker so the next person would see where the water had been going.

The next afternoon the leaves had lifted. Noor wrote a watering map: lettuce on odd days, tomatoes on even days, and a check of where the sprinkler actually pointed. She posted the map where the whole club could read it before anyone turned the water on. The can stayed on the path as a reminder of the old mistake.

Fill in the circle next to the best answer.

1. Why is the lettuce drooping?

- ☐ A. The watering map told them to skip the bed all week.
- ☐ B. Noor picked the lettuce before it could grow.
- ☐ C. The club flooded the bed until the leaves tore.
- ☐ D. The sprinkler has been watering the path, so the soil is dry.

2. How do they water once they know the soil is dry?

- ☐ A. By waiting three more days with no water
- ☐ B. Slowly, at the roots, without turning the bed to mud
- ☐ C. By flooding the plants as fast as they possibly can
- ☐ D. By aiming the sprinkler back at the path

3. What does the watering map prevent?

- ☐ A. The club from reading the instructions
- ☐ B. Another week of watering the path instead of the plants
- ☐ C. Tomatoes and lettuce from being watered on any day
- ☐ D. Anyone from moving the sprinkler ever again

Name: _____ Date: _____

Priya was pricing muffins at the bake sale when the scale stuck at four ounces. Every muffin, light or heavy, showed the same number. If she trusted it, people would pay the wrong amount, and the class would not be able to explain the totals later.

She set a labeled weight from the science kit on the tray. The scale still read four ounces. That proved the problem was the scale, not the muffins. Ms. Brooks brought a second scale from the office. Priya weighed the test weight again. This time the number matched the label. Only then did she weigh the muffins.

She taped a note to the stuck scale: Do not use. Prices followed the working scale, and Priya kept the test weight beside it so anyone could check. At the end of the sale, the money matched the price list. The broken scale never decided a price.

Fill in the circle next to the best answer.

1. What is wrong at the bake sale?

- ☐ A. The price list charges nothing for any item.
- ☐ B. The test weight from the science kit is missing.
- ☐ C. Ms. Brooks says muffins cannot be sold.
- ☐ D. The scale sticks at four ounces for every muffin.

2. How does Priya prove the scale is the problem?

- ☐ A. She changes the price list to match the stuck reading.
- ☐ B. A known weight still shows up as four ounces.
- ☐ C. She sells the muffins before she checks anything.
- ☐ D. The second scale sticks on the same number.

3. What does she do so nobody uses the bad scale?

- ☐ A. She hides the working scale in the office.
- ☐ B. She lets customers pick whichever number on the scale they like.
- ☐ C. She tapes a do-not-use note on it and prices with the other scale.
- ☐ D. She throws both scales away before the sale.

Name: _____ Date: _____

Leo's model bridge held a small book in the classroom and sagged under two books at home. The fair required the bridge to hold three books without touching the table. A flat deck with no supports was strong enough for one book and useless after that. Adding more glue only made the deck heavier.

His sister, a high school student who built stage sets, said triangles do not fold the way squares do. Leo cut two cardboard triangles and glued them under the deck, one near each end. He let the glue dry overnight instead of testing it while it was soft. The extra weight of wet glue would have cheated the test.

In the morning the bridge held three books and still cleared the table. Leo sketched the triangles on his display so judges could see why the shape mattered. The flat deck had failed. The triangles were the part that worked.

Fill in the circle next to the best answer.

1. What must Leo's bridge do at the fair?

- ☐ A. Hold three books without touching the table
- ☐ B. Hold one book and then be taken apart
- ☐ C. Stay flat so it can fold like a square
- ☐ D. Use only wet glue as the support

2. Why doesn't more glue solve the sag?

- ☐ A. His sister tells him triangles fold more easily.
- ☐ B. The fair no longer requires the bridge to hold books.
- ☐ C. It makes the deck heavier without stopping the fold.
- ☐ D. The glue dries before he can use it.

3. What change lets the bridge pass?

- ☐ A. A heavier book set on a flat deck
- ☐ B. Cardboard triangles glued under the deck
- ☐ C. Removing the deck so only the books remain
- ☐ D. Testing the bridge while the glue is still wet

Name: _____ Date: _____

The recycling truck arrived on Fridays at noon. On Thursday Sofia noticed cans in the paper bin and newspaper in the can bin. If the truck took the bins that way, the whole pickup could be rejected. Sorting it on Friday morning would be too late, because the truck sometimes came early.

Sofia did not dump both bins onto the grass. She spread a tarp and emptied the paper bin first. Cans clanked out of the newspaper. She dropped those into the can bin, then shook the can bin over a second corner of the tarp and returned any paper to its own bin. A friend held the bins so they would not tip.

Both bins matched their labels. Sofia clipped a picture card above each one: a can on one, a newspaper on the other. The Friday driver took them without a complaint. The cards stayed up so the next week would not start mixed.

Fill in the circle next to the best answer.

1. What problem does Sofia find on Thursday?

- ☐ A. The picture cards show the wrong materials.
- ☐ B. Cans and paper are in the wrong recycling bins.
- ☐ C. Friday morning is the only time sorting is allowed.
- ☐ D. The truck has already rejected a sorted pickup.

2. Why does she sort on Thursday instead of Friday?

- ☐ A. Paper and cans are supposed to share one bin.
- ☐ B. The truck sometimes arrives before Friday morning.
- ☐ C. Her friend can only help on Friday.
- ☐ D. The bins are locked until the truck comes.

3. How does she keep next week from starting mixed?

- ☐ A. She removes the labels so nobody gets confused.
- ☐ B. She asks the driver to sort the bins on the truck.
- ☐ C. She dumps both bins on the grass and leaves them.
- ☐ D. She clips a picture card above each bin.

Name: _____ Date: _____

Mei's garden map sent a new helper to the parking lot when the helper was looking for the tool shed. The north arrow pointed at the cars. Mei had drawn it while standing beside the metal cart, and she had trusted the compass without checking the sun. A map with the wrong north would mislead every new student.

She walked to the middle of the grass, away from the cart and the fence, and held the compass flat. The needle settled. She compared it with the shadows, which fell the way Mr. Chen had described at noon. The shed was east of the gate, not north. Mei erased the old arrow and redrew it.

She tested the map with a classmate who had not helped draw it. He found the shed on the first try. Mei wrote a note on the back: Check north away from metal. The arrow and the shadows finally agreed.

Fill in the circle next to the best answer.

1. What is wrong with Mei's garden map?

- ☐ A. The classmate already memorized the wrong path.
- ☐ B. Mr. Chen says maps should not have arrows.
- ☐ C. The north arrow points toward the parking lot.
- ☐ D. The tool shed was never built.

2. Why was the first compass reading unreliable?

- ☐ A. The sun and the shadows disagreed with every compass.
- ☐ B. The shed really was north of the gate.
- ☐ C. Mei used it beside a metal cart.
- ☐ D. She stood in the middle of the grass, away from metal.

3. How does Mei know the new arrow is right?

- ☐ A. The metal cart is moved onto the map.
- ☐ B. A classmate who did not draw the map finds the shed.
- ☐ C. She hides the compass so nobody can check her arrow.
- ☐ D. The arrow still points at the cars.

Name: _____ Date: _____

Hector's relay team kept dropping the baton. He was shouting "Go" when he was still several steps away, so his teammate started too early and had to look back. Looking back slowed her, and the pass arrived in the wrong hand. They were last in every practice heat.

Coach Ramirez filmed one exchange on a tablet and played it back. Hector saw the gap. The call had to come earlier, while he was still coming up, not when he was already beside her. They agreed on "Stick" at the start of the passing zone. His teammate would reach back without turning her head.

They practiced the zone four times. On the fifth, the baton met her hand and stayed there. In the next heat they did not win, but they did not drop it. Hector kept the word "Stick" written on his wristband so the call would not slide late again.

Fill in the circle next to the best answer.

1. Why does Hector's team drop the baton?

- ☐ A. He calls too late, so his teammate looks back.
- ☐ B. The wristband covers the word Go.
- ☐ C. Coach Ramirez removes the passing zone.
- ☐ D. His teammate refuses to reach back at all.

2. What does the filmed exchange show?

- ☐ A. The passing zone is longer than the whole track.
- ☐ B. The baton pass is perfect on the first try.
- ☐ C. The teammate never leaves the starting line.
- ☐ D. The call comes when Hector is already beside her.

3. What new call do they use?

- ☐ A. Go, when Hector is already beside her
- ☐ B. Stick, at the start of the passing zone
- ☐ C. Wait, after the baton has dropped
- ☐ D. Stop, so she will turn her head

Name: _____ Date: _____

The dough for family dinner sat in the bowl like a pale stone. Sam had followed the card, but the kitchen was cold because a window was open. An hour passed, and the dough had barely moved. Baking it flat would waste the flour, and dinner was not far off.

His grandmother pressed the dough with a finger and shook her head. She did not throw it out. She closed the window, set the bowl on a rack above the warm stove, and covered it with a damp towel. She told Sam to wait without peeking every minute. Peeking let the heat escape.

The next time they looked, the dough had domed over the rim. Sam shaped it into a pan. While it baked, the kitchen smelled like the bakery down the street. At dinner the bread was not perfect, but it was theirs. Sam wrote "warm spot, damp towel, window shut" on the recipe card so the next cold day would not stop the rise.

Fill in the circle next to the best answer.

1. Why doesn't the dough rise?

- ☐ A. His grandmother throws the flour out.
- ☐ B. An open window has made the kitchen too cold.
- ☐ C. The recipe card says to skip the rise.
- ☐ D. Sam peeked so often that the dough baked early.

2. What does his grandmother change?

- ☐ A. She tells Sam to peek every minute.
- ☐ B. She warms the bowl above the stove and covers it.
- ☐ C. She opens the window wider.
- ☐ D. She bakes the flat dough immediately in a cold oven.

3. What does Sam add to the recipe card?

- ☐ A. Instructions to bake the dough while it is still cold
- ☐ B. A reminder to leave the window open
- ☐ C. A note about a warm spot, a damp towel, and a shut window
- ☐ D. A warning never to let dough rise

Name: _____

Date: _____

The trail map had slipped out of Rosa's pocket somewhere on the switchbacks. The group stopped at a fork where both paths looked worn. Voices got quick. Splitting up to try both paths would make it harder for anyone to be found.

Mr. Ellis reminded them to stay together. Rosa remembered the ranger's morning talk: the creek stayed on the left all the way to the meadow. They listened and heard water over rocks. Rosa pointed left, and the group walked single file, watching for the blue trail marks she had forgotten until the sound of the creek brought them back.

The marks appeared again beside a fallen log. Ten minutes later the ranger met them at the meadow, already walking back to check on slow groups. He handed Rosa a spare map and showed her the zip pocket on her pack. She put the map there before she took another step.

Fill in the circle next to the best answer.

1. What problem does the group have at the fork?

- ☐ A. The map is lost, and both paths look possible.
- ☐ B. The creek has dried up and cannot be heard.
- ☐ C. Mr. Ellis tells them to split up.
- ☐ D. The ranger already has Rosa's only map.

2. What information does Rosa use instead of the map?

- ☐ A. The blue marks are only on the right-hand path.
- ☐ B. Mr. Ellis remembers every turn from last year.
- ☐ C. The ranger said the creek stays on the left.
- ☐ D. The louder voices mean the left path is closed.

3. How does Rosa keep from losing the next map?

- ☐ A. She leaves it beside the fallen log.
- ☐ B. She holds it in her hand for the rest of the year.
- ☐ C. She gives it back to the ranger at the fork.
- ☐ D. She zips the spare into the pocket on her pack.

Name: _____ Date: _____

The concert started in twenty minutes, and Diego's trumpet was not in the band-room cubby. He had practiced that morning and was sure he had set the case on the bench. The bench now held only a stack of music. Without a warm-up, his first notes would be unreliable.

He checked the practice rooms and the office. Then he opened the closet where extra stands were stored. His case was on the floor, shoved back when someone rolled a cart inside. The latch was still closed. He had just enough time to buzz a few notes in the hall. The first ones wobbled, then settled.

When the band entered, Diego watched the director's hands and came in on the beat. After the concert he slid the case onto the cubby shelf, not the bench. A shelf could not be cleared by a rolling cart. He checked the cubby again before he left. The case was still there.

Fill in the circle next to the best answer.

1. What is Diego missing before the concert?

- ☐ A. The key to the practice rooms
- ☐ B. His trumpet case
- ☐ C. The director's music
- ☐ D. A cart for the extra stands

2. Where does he find the case?

- ☐ A. In the office, open and empty
- ☐ B. On the closet floor, shoved back by a cart
- ☐ C. In the hall, where he left it to warm up
- ☐ D. On the bench, under the stack of music

3. Why does he stop storing the case on the bench?

- ☐ A. The shelf is too high for a closed latch.
- ☐ B. The cubby is only for stacks of music.
- ☐ C. The director asks him to leave the case out in the hall.
- ☐ D. A rolling cart can shove it off the bench and into the closet.

Name: _____ Date: _____

Lila's little brother had borrowed her library book and set a cup too close to the page. By the time she saw it, apple juice had soaked the chapter about bridges. The paper buckled, and the ink blurred. Hiding the book in her backpack would not undo the stain, and the report was due on Friday.

She took the book to the desk and showed Ms. Ortiz. Damaged books had to be replaced. Lila used money she had saved from feeding a neighbor's cat. She paid for the copy, and Ms. Ortiz ordered another one. Lila checked out a different bridges book so she could finish the report without waiting for the new copy to arrive.

That night she gave her brother a cup with a lid and moved the reading spot away from the table's edge. The report went in on time. The juice was an accident, but hiding it would have made it worse.

Fill in the circle next to the best answer.

1. What happened to Lila's library book?

- ☐ A. Ms. Ortiz lost it behind the desk.
- ☐ B. Juice soaked a chapter and blurred the ink.
- ☐ C. Her brother returned it undamaged.
- ☐ D. The bridges report was already turned in.

2. Why does Lila pay for a replacement?

- ☐ A. Ms. Ortiz says the stain will fade by Friday.
- ☐ B. She wants a second copy for her brother.
- ☐ C. Damaged library books have to be replaced.
- ☐ D. The neighbor's cat chewed the chapter.

3. How does she still finish the report on time?

- ☐ A. She copies the blurred pages and pretends they are clear.
- ☐ B. She hides the stained book and skips the report.
- ☐ C. She waits for the ordered copy to arrive next month.
- ☐ D. She checks out a different book about bridges.

Name: _____ Date: _____

The soccer field was mud from sideline to sideline. Passes that usually skimmed the grass stopped dead. Malik's team was down by one, and long kicks kept giving the ball away. Playing the dry-field game was making the mud worse for them.

Malik called his teammates into a huddle. He said they should pass short, to the nearest foot, and stay out of the deep puddle by the goal. The keeper, Amina, would roll the ball out instead of punting it into the mess. The plan was slower. It was also the only way to keep the ball.

Malik tapped a pass to Jonah, who slid it into the corner for the tying goal. Nobody cheered as if it were a championship, but they shook hands standing up instead of slipping. That night Malik wrote the short-pass idea in his notebook. Mud had changed the game, so the plan had to change too.

Fill in the circle next to the best answer.

1. Why are long passes a problem?

- ☐ A. Amina refuses to touch the ball.
- ☐ B. Short passes are against the rules in the mud.
- ☐ C. The other team has already left the field.
- ☐ D. They stop in the mud and give the ball away.

2. What does Malik ask the team to do?

- ☐ A. Punt every ball into the puddle by the goal
- ☐ B. Keep using the dry-field plan
- ☐ C. Stop playing until the mud dries
- ☐ D. Pass short and stay out of the deep puddle

3. What is the result of the new plan?

- ☐ A. The team loses by more goals.
- ☐ B. A short passing move leads to a tying goal.
- ☐ C. Malik quits and writes nothing down.
- ☐ D. Amina's punt wins the game immediately.

Name: _____ Date: _____

During quiet reading, Andre noticed the classroom fish hanging near the top of the tank. Their mouths broke the surface again and again. The filter, which usually hummed, was silent. Tapping the glass would only scare them. The fish were not playing. They were looking for air.

He told Mr. Chen, who lifted the filter and found it packed with gray gunk. Mr. Chen rinsed the filter in tank water, not soap, because soap would harm the fish. Andre held the bucket steady. When the filter clicked back on, a stream of bubbles rolled through the tank. By the end of reading, the fish had dropped to the middle of the water.

Andre added "Check the hum" to the tank job list. A quiet filter was a warning, not a peaceful sound. He listened for the hum every morning after that. The fish stayed in the middle, and the water stayed clear.

Fill in the circle next to the best answer.

1. What clue tells Andre something is wrong?

- ☐ A. The filter is humming louder than usual.
- ☐ B. Mr. Chen has already added soap to the fish tank.
- ☐ C. The job list says to tap the glass.
- ☐ D. The fish stay at the surface and the filter is silent.

2. Why is the filter rinsed in tank water?

- ☐ A. Andre wants the filter to stay silent.
- ☐ B. Soap would harm the fish.
- ☐ C. Gray gunk is food for the fish.
- ☐ D. The bucket is too small for clean water.

3. What does Andre add to the job list, and why?

- ☐ A. Check the hum, because a quiet filter means trouble.
- ☐ B. Tap the glass, because the fish enjoy it.
- ☐ C. Add soap, because it clears the gunk.
- ☐ D. Turn the filter off, because bubbles scare the fish.

Name: _____ Date: _____

The class play was that afternoon, and the lead, Priya, could barely speak. She had cheered too loudly at the morning game. Ms. Brooks looked at the cast and asked who knew the part. Canceling would disappoint the classes already sitting in the hall.

Camila had listened from the side during every practice, mouthing the lines while she waited for her small scene. She said she could try. At lunch she walked the stage alone and spoke the opening three times. When the curtain opened, her hands shook. She missed one word, paused, and kept going. The class followed the story anyway.

After the bow, Priya whispered that the pause had sounded like part of the line. Camila smiled. Watching had been practice, even when she was not in the spotlight. She kept the script in her folder. Next time she would not meet a new part for the first time in front of an audience.

Fill in the circle next to the best answer.

1. What problem hits the play on the day of the show?

- ☐ A. The audience leaves before the curtain opens.
- ☐ B. Camila refuses to attend the morning game.
- ☐ C. The lead loses her voice just before the performance.
- ☐ D. Ms. Brooks cancels every practice for the month.

2. Why can Camila try the part?

- ☐ A. The class already knows she is the lead.
- ☐ B. She memorized the script for the first time at lunch only.
- ☐ C. Priya writes her a new, shorter play.
- ☐ D. She has been mouthing the lines from the side at practice.

3. What does Camila learn from getting through the show?

- ☐ A. A pause means the play has failed.
- ☐ B. Paying attention offstage was practice for the real part.
- ☐ C. The lead's voice did not matter to the story.
- ☐ D. She should hide the script after opening night is over.

Name: _____ Date: _____

On the bus home, Amir grabbed a blue backpack from the seat and did not look at the tag. At his kitchen table he unzipped it and found a math folder with another name: Andre Ellis. His own backpack, with the class tablet, was still on the bus. Calling the school might be too late if the building had already locked.

The folder had a phone number inside the cover. Amir called. Andre had made the same mistake and was standing in his own kitchen with Amir's bag. They agreed to meet at the school office before it closed. Ms. Nguyen watched them trade bags and checked the tablet. The screen lit up. Nothing was cracked.

Amir looped a bright ribbon through his zipper that night. The next afternoon he checked the tag before he stepped off the bus. Andre did the same. The ribbon was a small change. It kept the tablet from riding home with the wrong person.

Fill in the circle next to the best answer.

1. What does Amir realize at the kitchen table?

- ☐ A. Ms. Nguyen sent him home with the wrong ribbon tied to his bag.
- ☐ B. The tablet screen is already cracked.
- ☐ C. He took Andre's backpack and left his own, with the tablet, on the bus.
- ☐ D. Andre's math folder belongs in Amir's bag.

2. How do the boys get the bags back?

- ☐ A. Amir keeps Andre's folder and forgets the tablet.
- ☐ B. The bus driver delivers both bags to the wrong houses.
- ☐ C. They wait until the next week to sort it out.
- ☐ D. They meet at the office and trade while Ms. Nguyen watches.

3. What does the ribbon help Amir do?

- ☐ A. Hide the tablet inside Andre's folder
- ☐ B. Leave his bag on the seat on purpose
- ☐ C. Check the tag before he gets off the bus
- ☐ D. Skip looking at the backpack entirely

Name: _____ Date: _____

The community garden tomatoes had split overnight. Heavy rain had soaked the ripe fruit, and the skins had burst in pale lines. If the class waited until Friday's harvest, many of the tomatoes would spoil on the vine. Green tomatoes were still firm. The split ones were the emergency.

Ivy brought a basket and scissors. She showed the group how to clip only the split fruit, leaving the firm green tomatoes to finish ripening. Juice stained her hands, but the basket filled quickly. They did not pull whole plants. A plant with green fruit still had work to do.

At lunch the class rinsed the pieces and set them out with salt. Students who usually skipped tomatoes took a cup. Ivy wrote "Pick ripe fruit after heavy rain" on the garden clipboard. The plants looked thinner, but they were healthier. The next rain would not find so much soft fruit waiting to break.

Fill in the circle next to the best answer.

1. What happened to the ripe tomatoes?

- ☐ A. The class picked them all on Friday as planned.
- ☐ B. The clipboard said to leave split fruit on the vine.
- ☐ C. Ivy cut down the green plants by mistake.
- ☐ D. Heavy rain split their skins.

2. Which tomatoes does the group pick?

- ☐ A. None, because Friday is the rule
- ☐ B. Only the split ones
- ☐ C. Only the firm green ones
- ☐ D. Every tomato, green or split

3. Why does Ivy write a note on the clipboard?

- ☐ A. So the club will pick ripe fruit after the next heavy rain
- ☐ B. So the class will wait until the split fruit spoils
- ☐ C. So the green tomatoes will be thrown out
- ☐ D. So nobody will rinse tomatoes again

Name: _____ Date: _____

The garden gate had a step only as high as a brick, but it stopped the supply cart. Wheels bumped, jars rattled, and water sloshed onto Hana's shoes. Carrying everything by hand took three trips, and one of those trips had already spilled a jar of seeds. The step was fine for people. It was a wall for wheels.

Hana asked Ms. Brooks if they could build a ramp. They measured the step and found a spare board in the shed. It was long enough to slope gently. A short board would have been too steep for a full water jug. Hana sanded the rough edge while Ms. Brooks braced the board so it would not slide.

They tested the cart with an empty tub first. It rolled up without a jolt. Then they tried the full jug. Hana kept one hand on the rail and one on the cart. The next work day, the whole club used the ramp. The step stayed for people who wanted it. The cart finally had a way in.

Fill in the circle next to the best answer.

1. What problem does the step cause?

- ☐ A. The shed has no spare boards at all.
- ☐ B. People cannot step into the garden.
- ☐ C. Ms. Brooks wants the cart left outside.
- ☐ D. The supply cart cannot roll over it.

2. Why does the board need to be long?

- ☐ A. A short board would make the ramp too steep.
- ☐ B. A long board is easier to hide in the shed.
- ☐ C. The step is taller than the gate.
- ☐ D. The empty tub will not roll on a gentle slope.

3. How do they know the ramp is safe to use?

- ☐ A. They test an empty tub before the full water jug.
- ☐ B. They remove the step so the cart is unnecessary.
- ☐ C. They send the full jug up on the first try.
- ☐ D. They carry the jars by hand and store the board.

Name: _____ Date: _____

The math team was supposed to explain a puzzle at the assembly. Ten minutes before they went on, their note cards were gone. A draft from the open door had blown the stack off the bleachers. Some cards were still readable. Some were not. Going on with blank hands would waste the explanation they had practiced.

Noah found two cards under the bottom row. The other three were smeared by a wet shoe print. He could read the titles but not the middle steps. His partner, Lila, said they still remembered the puzzle because they had built it. They whispered the steps in order: draw the chart, test one change, and check the result. Noah wrote fresh cards in big letters.

On stage, the chart made sense. A younger student even asked a question they could answer. Noah clipped the new cards into his folder before he left the gym. The lost cards had been a scare, not the end of the explanation.

Fill in the circle next to the best answer.

1. What happens to the math team's notes?

- ☐ A. A draft blows them off the bleachers and some get smeared.
- ☐ B. Noah memorizes them and soaks the cards on purpose.
- ☐ C. Lila throws them away before the assembly.
- ☐ D. The younger student takes them home.

2. How can they rebuild the middle steps?

- ☐ A. They invent a new puzzle on stage.
- ☐ B. The smeared cards are still easy to read.
- ☐ C. They remember the puzzle because they built it.
- ☐ D. The two dry cards contain every step.

3. What does Noah do with the new cards after the assembly?

- ☐ A. He throws them out because the talk is over.
- ☐ B. He leaves them on the bleachers again.
- ☐ C. He gives them to the younger student to keep.
- ☐ D. He clips them into his folder.

Name: _____ Date: _____

The school paper was stacked and ready for the copier. Jade read her article one last time and felt her stomach drop. She had written that the garden club met on Thursday. The club met on Tuesday. Fifty copies would spread the mistake before anyone could correct it in person.

She did not wait for someone else to notice. She told Mr. Patel, who ran the copier, and showed him the sentence. He had not started the machine. Together they opened the file, changed Thursday to Tuesday, and printed a single test page. Jade checked the date, the names, and the lunch menu before she nodded.

Then the copier began its steady work. Students would arrive at the garden on the right day. Jade kept a pencil in her pocket after that and read every article once more, sentence by sentence, before anyone printed a stack. The Tuesday meeting was full.

Fill in the circle next to the best answer.

1. What mistake is about to be copied?

- ☐ A. Mr. Patel has already printed fifty wrong copies.
- ☐ B. The article lists Thursday instead of Tuesday.
- ☐ C. The garden club has changed its meeting to Thursday.
- ☐ D. The lunch menu is missing from the paper.

2. Why can they still fix the file easily?

- ☐ A. The test page cannot be printed.
- ☐ B. Mr. Patel has not started the copier yet.
- ☐ C. Jade decides the wrong day does not matter.
- ☐ D. Fifty copies are already in students' hands.

3. What habit does Jade start after this?

- ☐ A. She asks Mr. Patel not to print test pages.
- ☐ B. She lets the first print run catch the errors.
- ☐ C. She stops writing the meeting day.
- ☐ D. She reads every article once more before it is copied.

Name: _____ Date: _____

Choir folders were passed down the row, and Nina's was short a page. The third page, the one with the key change, was gone. Singing the old key into the new section would clash with the rest of the choir. She could not invent the notes in front of an audience.

She checked the floor and the piano bench. Then she asked who had a complete folder. Ben's copy still had page 3. Ms. Brooks ran it through the copier, and Nina clipped the new page into her folder in order. She hummed the key change once, quietly, so her ear would expect it.

At the concert she came in on the new key with everyone else. Afterward she numbered the pages in the corner, even though they were already printed, because a quick glance had not been enough. A missing page was easy to miss until the music demanded it. Nina checked the folder corners before the next rehearsal.

Fill in the circle next to the best answer.

1. What is missing from Nina's folder?

- ☐ A. The page with the key change
- ☐ B. The copier that prints the folders
- ☐ C. Ben's copy of page 1
- ☐ D. The entire concert program

2. How does she replace the page?

- ☐ A. Ben gives her his only copy and sings from memory.
- ☐ B. Nina writes new notes without looking at anyone's music.
- ☐ C. She sings the old key and hopes it fits.
- ☐ D. Ms. Brooks copies page 3 from Ben's complete folder.

3. Why does she number the pages afterward?

- ☐ A. The key change was cut from the song.
- ☐ B. The printed numbers were wrong on purpose.
- ☐ C. Ms. Brooks asked her to remove page 3.
- ☐ D. A quick glance had not shown her the page was gone.

Name: _____ Date: _____

Ben's lab group was about to pour vinegar when he noticed a crack across his left lens. The rule was clear: no goggles, no experiment. Skipping his turn would leave the group one person short for the observations, and pouring without eye protection was not a choice he was willing to make.

He showed Ms. Ortiz the crack before anyone lifted a bottle. She set his goggles in the "do not use" bin and checked the spare drawer. One pair was left. Ben tried them on, and they sealed around his eyes. He still did not pour until she nodded. Then he recorded the fizz while his partners added the vinegar.

After class he wrote his name on a slip and taped it to the cracked pair so they would not wander back into the good drawer. The experiment was finished, and nobody's eyes had been the cost of getting it done.

Fill in the circle next to the best answer.

1. What stops Ben from starting the experiment?

- ☐ A. The spare drawer is full of cracked pairs.
- ☐ B. A crack in his goggles breaks the safety rule.
- ☐ C. The vinegar bottle is empty.
- ☐ D. Ms. Ortiz cancels observations for the day.

2. What does he do before anyone pours?

- ☐ A. He pours carefully without goggles.
- ☐ B. He tells his partners to skip the observations.
- ☐ C. He shows Ms. Ortiz and switches to a spare pair.
- ☐ D. He peels the crack off the lens and continues.

3. Why does he label the cracked pair?

- ☐ A. So it will not be put back with the good goggles
- ☐ B. So the experiment can be repeated without eye protection
- ☐ C. So he can use it again tomorrow
- ☐ D. So the spare pair will be thrown away

Name: _____ Date: _____

Felix's group had finished a poster about the water cycle, and it would not fit the bulletin board. The paper hung past the frame on both sides. Cutting through the drawings would remove the labels. Folding the edges hid the arrows that showed evaporation. The board was the size it was. The poster had to change without losing information.

They measured the frame and the poster. The extra was only a blank margin. Felix marked a pencil line inside the margin, away from every word and arrow. The group cut along the line, then checked that each label was still complete. Nothing important sat on the strip they removed.

The poster fit the frame with a finger's width to spare. They pinned it flat. From the hallway, the cycle could be read from evaporation to rain and back. Felix kept the trimmed strips in the project folder as proof they had cut paper, not content.

Fill in the circle next to the best answer.

1. What is the problem with the poster?

- ☐ A. It is wider than the bulletin board.
- ☐ B. Folding the edges makes the arrows easier to see.
- ☐ C. The water cycle labels are already missing.
- ☐ D. The frame is larger than the hallway.

2. Why don't they fold the edges or cut through the drawings?

- ☐ A. Folding hides arrows, and cutting drawings would remove labels.
- ☐ B. The margin is full of words they need.
- ☐ C. Pencil lines are not allowed anywhere on project paper.
- ☐ D. The board can be widened to fit any poster.

3. What do they actually cut off?

- ☐ A. The evaporation label
- ☐ B. Only the blank margin
- ☐ C. The frame of the bulletin board
- ☐ D. The arrows that show the cycle

Name: _____

Date: _____

Luis counted the class store money and came up three dollars short of the price list. The drawer looked honest. Nobody had left early, and the items sold matched the tally sheet. A missing three dollars would have to be reported, but reporting a mistake he had not checked would waste the teacher's time.

He separated the bills instead of trusting the stack. Two five-dollar bills were stuck together so tightly they felt like one. He had counted them once. When he peeled them apart, the total matched the sheet. He held each bill up to the window to be sure no third bill was hiding.

Luis wrote the new total and paper-clipped the fives so they could not glue themselves together again. He told Ms. Patel what he had found. The store was not short. The count had been. From then on he fanned the bills before he added them.

Fill in the circle next to the best answer.

1. What does the first count suggest?

- ☐ A. The store is three dollars short of the price list.
- ☐ B. Two five-dollar bills were never in the drawer.
- ☐ C. The tally sheet lists the wrong items.
- ☐ D. Ms. Patel already knows the bills are stuck.

2. What does Luis discover when he separates the bills?

- ☐ A. A bill is missing and cannot be replaced.
- ☐ B. The price list is three dollars too high.
- ☐ C. The window light changes the total again.
- ☐ D. Two fives were stuck together and counted as one.

3. How does he keep the same mistake from happening again?

- ☐ A. He reports a shortage without recounting.
- ☐ B. He stops writing totals for the store.
- ☐ C. He fans the bills before he adds them.
- ☐ D. He paper-clips every bill into one thick stack.

Name: _____ Date: _____

Theo's debate team dumped their cards on the table and could not tell which arguments were for the new park and which were against it. Both sets were written on white cards. In the practice round they read an "against" card during the "for" speech. The judge stopped them. Mixed evidence would lose the real debate even if the speakers were loud.

Theo got two colors of sticky notes from the supply shelf. The group marked every "for" card with green and every "against" card with yellow, then read each card aloud before they stuck the note on. One card did not fit either side. They set it aside instead of forcing it into a pile.

They ran the speech again. Green cards stayed in the first speech. Yellow cards stayed in the second. The judge nodded when the sides no longer collided. Theo clipped each pile into its own envelope. Color was a simple fix. It kept the argument from arguing with itself.

Fill in the circle next to the best answer.

1. What goes wrong in the practice round?

- ☐ A. Green and yellow notes are already on every card.
- ☐ B. Theo refuses to sort the evidence.
- ☐ C. The team reads an against card during the for speech.
- ☐ D. The judge says the park topic is canceled.

2. How do they sort the cards?

- ☐ A. They put all the cards into one envelope.
- ☐ B. They guess the color without reading the card.
- ☐ C. They mark for cards green and against cards yellow.
- ☐ D. They throw out every card that mentions the park.

3. What happens to the card that fits neither side?

- ☐ A. They set it aside instead of forcing it into a pile.
- ☐ B. They read it in both speeches.
- ☐ C. The judge uses that card as the team's closing argument.
- ☐ D. They color it both green and yellow.

Name: _____ Date: _____

Cole checked the rain gauge after the storm and wrote two inches in the log. The number bothered him. The puddles were deep, but the gauge sat tilted against the fence, and the water line inside it was crooked. A tilted gauge does not measure a straight inch. Recording the crooked line would make the week's data useless.

He did not erase the two and replace it with a guess. He set the gauge upright, checked it with a small level from the shed, and poured the water into a straight measuring cup. The cup showed an inch and a half. Cole wrote that number, plus a note that the first reading was from a tipped gauge and should not be graphed.

He pushed a stake beside the gauge so it could not lean on the fence again. The next storm's reading was a clean line. The log finally showed weather, not a crooked tube.

Fill in the circle next to the best answer.

1. Why is Cole unsure about the two-inch reading?

- ☐ A. The storm never happened.
- ☐ B. The measuring cup is missing from the shed.
- ☐ C. The gauge is tilted, so the water line is crooked.
- ☐ D. The log already says an inch and a half.

2. How does he get a reading he can trust?

- ☐ A. He stands the gauge up and pours the water into a straight cup.
- ☐ B. He leaves the gauge against the fence.
- ☐ C. He graphs the crooked line because it was written first.
- ☐ D. He guesses a new number and erases the note.

3. What keeps the gauge from tipping again?

- ☐ A. He records every storm as two inches.
- ☐ B. The fence is removed from the garden.
- ☐ C. A stake stops it from leaning on the fence.
- ☐ D. Cole takes the gauge inside for the rest of the year.

Name: _____

Date: _____

Amina had written three sentences about the book drive for the morning announcements. At the microphone her mouth went dry. The first practice, alone in the hall, came out in a rush, and she stumbled on the word donations. If she rushed on the real announcement, classes would not know where to bring books.

Mr. Patel let her try twice more before the bell. The second time she still tripped on that word. The third time she paused after each sentence, the way he showed her, and the word came out whole. He nodded and turned the speaker on. The pause felt long to her. On the speaker it sounded like a period.

Amina heard her own voice in the hall. It was smaller than she expected and clearer than she feared. Two students later asked where to bring books. She taped the script into her notebook with the pauses marked. The next announcement would still make her nervous. She would not meet it for the first time at the live microphone.

Fill in the circle next to the best answer.

1. What goes wrong in Amina's first practice?

- ☐ A. Students already know where to bring books, so she stops.
- ☐ B. Mr. Patel turns the speaker on before she is ready.
- ☐ C. She rushes and stumbles on the word donations.
- ☐ D. The script has no sentences about the book drive.

2. What change helps her say the word?

- ☐ A. She pauses after each sentence.
- ☐ B. She removes the word from the script.
- ☐ C. She reads faster so the word blurs past.
- ☐ D. She waits until the live announcement to practice.

3. Why does she save the marked script?

- ☐ A. So students will not ask her where they should bring the books
- ☐ B. So Mr. Patel will cancel the book drive
- ☐ C. So the next announcement is not her first time at the microphone
- ☐ D. So she can rush through it without pauses

Name: _____ Date: _____

Omar's geology display had two rocks with the labels swapped. The rough gray one was marked sandstone, and the smooth reddish one was marked granite. He knew that was backward because the class had tested them: granite scratched the glass plate, and sandstone did not. Visitors who trusted the cards would learn the wrong fact.

He did not rewrite the cards from memory alone. He repeated the scratch test on a spare plate while Ms. Nguyen watched. The gray rock scratched the glass. The reddish rock left a dusty streak and did not scratch. Those results matched his notes, not the cards on the table.

Omar switched the labels and taped them on the bottom as well as the front, so a bump could not swap them again. He added the test result in small print: scratches glass, or does not. The display finally said what the rocks had already proved.

Fill in the circle next to the best answer.

1. What is wrong with Omar's display?

- ☐ A. Neither rock will scratch glass.
- ☐ B. The sandstone and granite labels are on the wrong rocks.
- ☐ C. Ms. Nguyen removes the spare glass plate from the table.
- ☐ D. The notes match the swapped cards.

2. How does he decide which label is correct?

- ☐ A. He repeats the scratch test and checks it against his notes.
- ☐ B. He trusts the cards that are already sitting on the table.
- ☐ C. He labels both rocks sandstone.
- ☐ D. He asks visitors which rock looks harder.

3. Why does he tape labels on the bottom too?

- ☐ A. So a bump cannot swap them again
- ☐ B. So the scratch test can be skipped
- ☐ C. So the gray rock can be called sandstone
- ☐ D. So visitors will not see any labels